

AN ORGAN DONATED SAVES A LIFE

Phenomenal transformation has been witnessed in medicine where highly advanced technology assisted techniques are a reality in conducting complex procedures such as organ transplant, which has grown as a specialization in itself. Today, organ transplantation considered as a miracle of twentieth century, not only increases life expectancies and improves the quality of life, it remains the best last resort for replacing terminal and irreparable organ damage. Today, organ transplant procedures in India headed by experts in the specialization, are ensuring treatment comparable to the best in the world and affordable, as well, which is attracting patients from different countries.



Gaining World Prominence

Organ transplantation has come a long way after the first successful transplant carried out in 1954, which was also the first living donor kidney transplant, by the legendary Dr. Joseph Murray. Every year, August 13 is observed as World Organ Donation Day, but in 2023, the Indian Organ Donation Day, which was started in 2010, under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare by the National Organ and Tissue Transplant Organization (NOTTO), was shifted to 3rd August. It was done so to coincide with the commemoration of the first successful cadaver heart transplant done in India on August 3rd, 1994. This year the theme of the World Organ Donation

Day 2023 is "Step up to volunteer; need more organ donors to fill the lacunae" emphasising on the universal appeal to communities on the significance of making a pledge to donate an organ to help bridge the gap.

World Organ Donation Day emphasizes on:

- Saving lives
- Improving quality of life
- Addressing organ shortage
- Promoting medical advancement
- Enhancing generosity and empathy
- Inculcating social responsibility
- Ensuring ethical practices
- Reducing healthcare costs
- Global impact on people
- Comforting grieving families

Significance of Organ Transplantation

What makes organ transplantation significant is the fact that it not only brings hope to many terminally ill patients with organ failure by saving their lives, but also ensures quality life. Transplant is a medical procedure in which a donor's healthy organ is removed and is surgically replaced in the recipient having a damaged or missing organ.

The organs that can be transplanted are namely the liver, kidney, pancreas, heart, lung, intestine, face, hand and uterus. The four different types of organ transplants that are carried out are living donation, cadaver donation, tissue donation and paediatric donation. In India, organ donation law, both for the deceased and living donors, is regulated by the Transplantation of Human Organs and Tissues Act, (THOTA), 1994. The National Organ and Tissue Transplant Registry was established to maintain records of organ donations



The FMT also reduces the leakiness of the bowel, preventing the bacteria from moving out. They allow the food to be processed properly and improve nutrition in the patients; the bad bacteria are alcohol dependent."

Dr. S K Sarin, V-C, ILBS on Faecal Transplants

and transplantation in the country to help formulate policies and strategies to promote organ donation and transplantation.

Technology Advancements

Minimally invasive or key-hole techniques for procedures is a reality because of technological advancements. AI has proved to be a disruptor enabling high-precision surgeries where laparoscopic and robotic interventions are giving high success rates in the range of 90's. Robotic surgery offers better manoeuvrability, 3D vision, which helps in conducting the most difficult operations with negligible collateral damage, better



"Over 15,000 organ donations are now made annually in the country as compared to 5,000 in 2013, There cannot be a greater service to humanity than giving life to another person."

Shri. Mansukh Mandaviya, Union Health Minister